DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 4

Video editor

Profession 4 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A video editor shapes raw footage into a finished piece: cutting, pacing, sound, titles and colour, for ads, films, courses or social media.

What professionals do every day

Reviews footage, builds a rough cut, refines pacing and sound, adds titles and graphics, grades colour, exports for each platform and manages client feedback.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Video is the most used format for marketing and learning. Editors turn long recordings into short, clear, engaging content.

- Long footage that loses the viewer.
- Bad audio and inconsistent colour.
- Exports that fail on the target platform.

Skills you need

- Story structure and pacing.
- Cutting on the beat; J and L cuts.
- Audio levels and music licensing.
- Colour basics.
- File formats and export settings.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
DaVinci Resolve	Editing and colour	Free version	Paid studio	www.blackmagicdesign.com/products/davinciresolve
Adobe Premiere Pro	Professional editing	Trial	Subscription	www.adobe.com/products/premiere.html
CapCut	Short social edits	Free	Paid features	www.capcut.com
Descript	Edit video by editing text	Free tier	Paid plans	www.descript.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish

Beginner	Cut a two-minute interview to one minute.
Intermediate	Edit a 30-second ad with music and titles.
Advanced	Produce a three-part course series with consistent style.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Social reel series for a shop.
- **Intermediate:** Testimonial video.
- **Advanced:** Explainer for a product launch.

Client-ready portfolio project

A 60-second promotional video for a fictional business: rough cut, fine cut, sound mix, titles, colour and three exports (square, vertical, widescreen).

Worked example

Worked example. A 40-second testimonial is cut to 25 seconds by removing pauses and keeping the strongest sentence first, then the title appears on the first frame.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

A 60-second promo in three exports

Business problem: A shop needs one promo video for three platforms.

Steps

1. Cut the footage to 60 seconds with a clear opening.
2. Balance dialogue and music so speech is always clear.
3. Grade the colour for one consistent look.
4. Export square, vertical and widescreen versions.

Expected output: Three exports and a settings note.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Speech stays above the music by about 10 dB. The vertical version keeps titles inside the safe area. The settings note records codec, resolution and frame rate for the client's team.

Common mistakes

- Leaving pauses and filler words in.
- Music louder than the voice.
- Titles outside the safe area on phones.
- Exporting without checking the file on a phone.

Freelancing opportunities

- Short-form editing retainers.
- Course and training video editing.
- Briefs for 'video editing', 'reels', 'YouTube editor'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- DaVinci Resolve training (official)
- Adobe Premiere Pro help

Part of **Master Freelancing: Design and Creative**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.